GREEN SKILLS Unit 5

SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT

Sustainable development is the development that satisfies the needs of the present without compromising the capacity of future generations, guaranteeing the balance between economic growth, care for the environment and social well-being.

The important principles of sustainable development are as follows

- To carefully utilize all resources.
- To conserve resources so that they meet the demands and requirements of the future generations.
- To minimize the depletion of natural resources.
- Respect and care for all forms of life.
- People should learn to conserve the natural resources in order to protect the living beings.
- Conserving the Earth's vitality and diversity.
- Improving the quality of human life.
- Changing personal attitude and practices towards the environment.

IMPORTANCE OF SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT

Sustainable development is necessary for the maintenance of the environment. The importance of sustainable development is as follows:

- **Efficient use of resources:** Encourages careful and optimal use of resources without waste, helping protect the environment.
- Positive attitude: Builds awareness and responsibility to conserve natural resources as shared assets.
- People's participation: involves communities in development, increasing responsibility and interest in conservation.
- Limited use of resources: Promotes controlled use of limited and non-renewable resources to meet basic needs.
- Long-term development: Aims for economic and social progress while preserving resources for future generations.

Sustainable Development Goals: Sustainable development has three main components economy, environment and social inclusion. It seeks to ensure economic development, while protecting the environment through participation of the societies and communities. The United Nations Sustainable Development Summit 2015, has set seventeen specific goals towards achieving sustainable development.

GOALS OF SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT

1. No Poverty
2. Zero Hunger
3. Good Health and Well-being
4. Quality Education
5. Gender Equality
6. Clean Water and Sanitation

7. Affordable and Clean Energy
8. Decent Work and Economic Growth
9. Industry, Innovation and Infrastructure
10. Reduced Inequalities
11. Sustainable Cities and Communities
12. Responsible Consumption and Production
13. Climate Action
14. Life Below Water
15. Life on Land
16. Peace, Justice and Strong Institutions
17. Partnerships for the Goals

These above 17 objectives are interrelated and often the key to one's success will involve the issues most frequently linked to another.

They can be summarized as follows in short:

- Eradicate poverty and hunger, guaranteeing a healthy life
- Universalize access to basic services such as water, sanitation and sustainable energy
- Support the generation of development opportunities through inclusive education and decent work
- Foster innovation and resilient infrastructure, creating communities and cities able to produce and consume sustainably
- Reduce inequality in the world, especially that concerning gender
- Care for the environment combating climate change and protecting the oceans and land ecosystems
- Promote collaboration between different social agents to create an environment of peace and sustainable development.

PROBLEMS RELATED TO SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT

Some problems related to sustainable development are as follows:

- Poor management of natural resources combined with growing economic activities will continue to pose serious challenges to environment.
- The most significant environmental problems are associated with resources that are renewable such as air and water. They have finite capacity to assimilate emissions and wastes but if pollution exceeds this capacity ecosystem can deteriorate rapidly.
- To assess the regenerative capacity of natural resources is difficult. In the cases of soil erosion, atmospheric pollution etc., there is substantial uncertainty about the extent and outcomes of environmental degradation.
- The overall effects of economic activities on the environment are continuously changing.
- Due to rise in income, the demands for improvement in environmental quality will increase as well as the resources available for investment but it is not mandatory in some cases as problems are observed to get worse as income rise.
- Rise in population is another problem that would further lead to severe environmental degradation in the future.
- Another challenge is rise in demand for energy as it is estimated that the total manufacturing outputs in developing countries will increase to about six times the current levels by 2030.
- Another challenge is rise in demand of food crops with the growth of population. To protect fragile soils and natural habitats, this will have to be achieved by raising yields on existing crop land.

IMPORTANCE OF SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT:

Sustainable development is essential for protecting the environment while promoting human welfare. Ignoring its principles can reduce the effectiveness of development efforts.

Key Points:

- **Efficient Use of Resources**: Encourages minimizing the use of resources like water, fossil fuels, chemicals, and forest products to maximize benefits without waste, supporting environmental conservation.
- **Promotes Positive Attitudes**: Raises awareness about the shared responsibility to preserve natural resources and fosters respect for the environment.
- **Focus on Core Development Areas**: Supports progress in health, education, agriculture, tourism, and social reforms while integrating environmental protection.
- **People's Participation**: Involving local communities in development encourages ownership, engagement, and protection of natural resources.
- **Limits to Development**: Advocates for using resources within sustainable limits, avoiding overexploitation driven by greed.
- **Long-term Goals**: Seeks economic and social growth without depleting resources, ensuring that future generations can also benefit.

CHALLENGES OF SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT:

Global challenges to sustainable development include poverty, social exclusion, unemployment, climate change, conflicts, weak governance, and ensuring peace and the rule of law.

To address these, the United Nations established the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) under Agenda 2030 (United Nations Sustainable Development Summit, 2015), which aim to:

- End poverty and hunger worldwide.
- Ensure health, well-being, and quality education for all.
- Achieve gender equality and empower women and girls.
- Provide access to clean water, sanitation, and sustainable energy.
- Promote inclusive economic growth, decent work, and innovation.
- Build robust infrastructure and sustainable cities.
- Reduce inequalities within and between countries.
- Ensure sustainable consumption, production, and climate action.
- Conserve oceans, forests, and biodiversity.
- Foster peaceful, inclusive societies and global partnerships.